

Lazie Indie Magazine

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Content

Editors Corner

The Hammond Brothers
Sadu

Annmarie Picerno

Roger Adams
Zak Ambrose

Samantha Noella

Music for World Peace Records
Jeff Stone

Gary Harvey

Vijit Malik
Brian Stepien- Soul Chatter

Breezer Vivid Shuffle

Interviews

- 1) Organizer: Arti Hajela (Breezer)
- 2) Winner : GD 47 -Gagandeep Singh
- 3) Winner : Bboy Tornado- Ramesh Yadav
- 4) Winner: Neeraj Pandey
- 5) Winner: Mooz One - Raj Pathare
- 6) Winner: Creative Dance Crew



Editors Corner

Information

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Thank you for your support
We are a year old

Well! we have completed a year with this edition of [Lazie Indie Magazine](#). What started as a small effort to share stories of fellow Independent musicians has culminated into a full-fledged Magazine featuring some of the best artists in the world both Indie and mainstream with great songs to their credit. Our motto was that we will present an artist in detail and have carefully chosen artists on the interview chart rather than crowding the mag with too many artists sharing a small column each. Though this meant that we could only cover a few artists in each edition we are proud that we have covered more than 100 artists in detail and our readers got to know them well. This edition too, has a very exciting line up as usual. We have legendary artists sharing space with promising & upcoming talents. We have a veteran musician from India who was a sensation in the 90's, we have a legendary duo that the great Glen Campbell loved to listen to. We have quite a few great artists who are respected all around the world and have great music with them. So friends let share the magazine as much as we can. Each artist featured here deserves to be heard and read about a lot more. This edition cover too is different. We have shown in our cover this time that we are all a part of one community which is the music community. All artists featured in the magazine are number one in their own rights. [Lazie Indie Magazine](#) is proud to have interviewed and featured them. We also are featuring one of the top Hip Hop leagues in India and have the winners and the organizers interviewed in detail. So let us start reading now. So as I always say read and share as much as you can. Support Independent Music. Thank you for you continued support & Have a great time - Jay

The Hammond Brothers





They have been together even before they came to this world. From the age of 5 they have been performing. Their harmonies are natural and organic as they have been singing them all through their life. It was only natural for the world to notice them and ever since they have hit the scene, they are sailing through with their inspiring music and awesome harmonies along with their unique comedy shows. They have toured with the likes of Glen Campbell, Kenny Rogers, George Strait and many more. Glen Campbell said *"anyone who said they couldn't hear the great sibling harmony of The Hammond Brothers, simply had ears without holes"*. Do we need to say more? Jay from [Lazie Indie Magazine](#) had the honor to speak to Americana Hall of Fame Inductees, Josie Winners - **Gale** and **Dale Hammond** also called **The Hammond Brothers**. Let's check...





Jay: Hello Dale and Gale Welcome !

You have had an illustrious career so far in music spanning across decades. Now when you look back, what do you tell yourselves about the journey so far?

The Hammond Bros: Well, we always stay humble first and foremost. We're constantly reminded just how lucky and blessed we've been throughout our journey. We've met so many wonderful people along the way and now we tell ourselves it's all been worth it.

Jay: Read that your early career was shaped by your Church music roots. Why did you choose this genre of music? Who were your early influences?

The Hammond Bros: From a young age we learned about the gospel through church hymns and came to know them as almost a second language. Our early influences were Simon & Garfunkel, Elvis Presley and The Everly Brothers among many others.

Jay: Your harmonies and even the overall act look like it is free-flowing. Is it because you are twins that the vibe is so strong & natural?

The Hammond Bros: Well, being together from the day of birth we believe that the state of naturality and symbiosis was developed in the womb. Everyone we knew told us when we were young boys they knew we were born to sing and entertain.

Jay: You have toured/worked with Legends of Country Music like Glen Campbell, George Strait, Kenny Rogers and many others. Can you recollect your time with them

The Hammond Bros: Yes, we think about those times often. Some of our favorite past memories involve touring and performing alongside legendary musicians and singers. The first time we met Glen was in Las Vegas, NV at the Frontier Hotel. We opened the show and over a period of months we became close friends and would often get together after sets to tell stories. Glen once told us that anyone who said they couldn't hear the great sibling harmony we had, simply had ears without holes.



"There's always this feeling of determination when you write, record and perform in a live audience especially when you want your message to come across their ears and minds".

We love and miss him. The first time we met George was in Oklahoma City. We opened the show for him and he'd always take off his hat to keep from being recognized so he could hear a couple of our songs before he was about to take the stage. He is a wonderful family man and is our friend to this day. In Las Vegas, we were working with Walter Cane. Our booking agent at the time. We were invited to play in a celebrity softball game. When we got there Kenny Rogers and many other greats were there. When we got to the dugout, we saw Alice Cooper walk in. We'd never seen someone with such wild hair before so Gale asked him if he wanted to borrow a comb. What a funny memory to look back on. As young boys, Ray Walker of the Jordainnaires once took us to Elvis Presley's home, Graceland. We stood around the piano in

his living room and sang gospel songs with Elvis. That is one of our most fond memories.

Jay: Who among you writes the lyrics? How do you go about creating music? What do you look to convey through your music?

The Hammond Bros: We collaborate together on all the songs. Collectively bouncing ideas back and forth. We reflect on life experiences and use inspiration from the people we meet and the places we've seen to create the harmony and songs you hear today. We seek to give back all that has been given to us throughout our entire careers in the form of music. We hope to convey that life is the most precious gift to us all and that the wonder of music can break through any wall or barrier to unite us as one.





"The first time we met Glen was in Las Vegas, NV at the Frontier Hotel. We opened the show and over a period of months we became close friends and would often get together after sets to tell stories. Glen once told us that anyone who said they couldn't hear the great sibling harmony we had, simply had ears without holes".

Jay: How do you produce your music? Do you do it yourself or do you look to producers to bring in their ideas into your music?

The Hammond Bros: We've found that very few producers didn't share the same vision for the music in the way that we do. One producer who happened to think parallel to us was the legendary Fred Foster of our former label Monument Records. We like to keep all restrictions at bay when producing our own music so that we may have the ability to experiment and be flexible in the way that seems natural for our own sound.

Jay: What gives you the kick? Writing, producing or performing live and why?

The Hammond Bros: All the above, but each one has their special moments. We would have to say that performing live has to be our favorite. Interacting

with fans and friends, seeing the joy and happiness our music is able to bring to people. There is just nothing like experiencing it face to face.

Jay: You do a lot of humor in your live shows. Do you plan your show with music and comedy as a complete act or it is impromptu on stage?

The Hammond Bros: Our song set list is always arranged before each show but as far as the comedy goes, we usually get a feel for the audience we are performing in front of. Then we'll use the audience's energy to intertwine our humor into the show.

Jay: The current Covid scare and lockdowns have clearly put the live music industry on the mat. How long do you think this will continue and what do you suggest an upcoming artist to stay afloat during these tough times?



The Hammond Bros: Like everyone else, we are all hoping that all countries can get back to a time of health and peace more so than ever before. In the meantime, we've been finding balance in getting back to our roots and we believe that these trying times will inspire our music in a way that has never happened before. We've been using our down time to constantly write and record. As far as a timeline, we don't have any speculations as to how long it may continue. We just hope for the best outcome and that all the world leadership are able to efficiently come together to eradicate this pandemic as soon as possible. Finding new ways to stimulate the mind whether it be starting a new exercise routine, learning a new language or picking up your old rusty guitar. It's never too late to explore all the things life has to offer.

Jay: You have traveled all over Europe and of course the USA. Have you ever toured Asia and India in particular? Will

you be looking to travel this part of the world with your music?

The Hammond Bros: We absolutely would love to come to Asia and India! As soon as travel restrictions and international travel has returned to full scale, we absolutely plan to make it to that beautiful part of the world!

Jay: Where can one find your music on the internet and what would you say to a totally new listener to look forward to in your music?

The Hammond Bros: You can find us at www.TheHammondBrothers.com
Spotify
Instagram
Facebook

Jay: Thank you Dale and Gale!
It was an absolute honor to speak to you.

The Hammond Bros: Thank you.

Courtesies: Barbara Harkins, DJ Grant and Shelby Craft.

Sadu





The 1990s was a decade that gave rise to a very powerful Independent music movement in India with Hindi Indie Bands coming to fore. One of the leading bands during the time was 'Aryans' the first boy band of India which had a number of block busters to its credit. [Lazie Indie Magazine](#) catches up with [Sadasivan Nambisan](#) aka [Sadu](#) one of the founder members of 'Aryans'. [Sadu](#) has not just been with Aryans but has later on released and still releases hits year on year. The latest release is 'Habeeb' which came out in March 2021. The most notable thing about this veteran musician is that he still remains true to Independent music maintaining his freedom and not falling with the flock which normally moves to Bollywood and the remix regime. Let's ask [Sadu](#) about his phenomenal career so far and his immediate future plans...



"It is a fact that the might of music companies and the kind of promotions they do is enormous, I feel Internet era is a blessing in disguise for all those brilliant and talented musicians for whom showcasing their songs to the world is on fingertips. Nevertheless internet has provided excess to many digital music streaming platforms and there are few which runs on algorithms and the playlist is genuinely compiled of the merit and song content" .

Jay: Hi Sadu, welcome to Lazie Indie Magazine. You have had a great career so far in music which needs to be told to our readers across the globe so for the benefit of our readers can you kindly introduce yourself. Where are you from and how did you become "Sadu" and how did Aryans come into being?

Sadu: I was born in Payyanur, Kerala and brought up in Aruvankadu, The Nilgiris, Tamil Nadu and later in Itarsi/ Bhopal, Madhya Pradesh. In early 90's I used to play the keyboards and sing few classical based songs in Orchestras. My name is Sadasivan KM Nambisan, my mom used to call me by the nick name Sadu, this became my musical name. While performing live shows I started to write, compose and sing my own songs, then I met DJ Narain. DJ also had the same kind of art as mine.

I shifted to Mumbai, we recorded some demos and approached many Music Companies, we were called by Polygram Records, there we met Jai Walia with the same talent. Polygram liked our demos and decided to launch the first ever Boy Band of India. They roped in Lalit Sen to do the music for us. In a closed brainstorming session to name the band, out of the blue came a name "The Aryans" which all of us liked instantly. That's how Aryans was born.

Jay: Who were your musical influences and how does it reflect in the genre of music do you create?

Sadu: In my childhood my subconscious mind was fed with Malayalam, Tamil and of course Hindi film songs. The amalgamation of all three languages helped me a lot to absorb three different cultures, style and arrangements.





Yesudas was and still is one of my favourite singer. Mohammed Rafi, Kishore Kumar, Talat Mehmood & Lata Mangeshkar were the singers I grew up listening to. Indian Music Directors like Madan Mohan, Salil Choudhri, Ilaiyaraaja, S D & R D Burman and Roshan impressed me a lot. I was hooked up to few western artists as well like Queen, The Beatles, Eagles, Brian Adams, Boney M, ABBA, George Michael and of course Michael Jackson. While doing my masters degree in chemistry I started listening to ghazals rendered by Ghulam Ali, Mehdi Hassan, Jagjit Singh etc. In early 80's Hindi independent music scene of this sub continent was taken by storm introducing Nazia and Zoheb Hasan's 'Disco Deewane'. The music was by Biddu, later on they came up with 'Aap jaisa koi meri zindagi mein aaye' likewise a pop album 'Chahat' by Ali Haider was released, I should admit this song 'chahat' and 'gora rang ka zamana' was the game changer of my life. That's when I knew what exactly to do in my life. All these influences helped me carve a niche of my own while creating a track.

Jay: Aryans was a very popular act in the 1990s and was one of the torchbearers of Independent music during those days in an otherwise Film music-dominated environment., Can you tell us how you went about creating the band and how did you break into the national scene?

Sadu: In early 1998 our band Aryans was officially formed and polygram released our first album "Ankhon mein Tera hi chehra" later that year, which broke all sales record of those times. That's when we received a pan Indian identity. I believe from 1993 to 2003 was the golden era of Indian Independent music, the decade of best Independent music acts the country had ever witnessed, we were indeed blessed to be a part of it. Polygram was then named as Universal Music India. So with Universal Music we came out with our second album of ten songs in the year 2000 called "Yeh hawa kehti hai kya". This too was a craze among the youth, MTV & Channel V regularly helped out the independent music reach millions of audience, we were indeed giving a run for money to the film songs. We then did lots of concerts around the globe. In 2002 came our third album Dekha hai Teri aankhon ko .. yet another block buster..

Jay: As an Independent musician not bound by "BOX OFFICE" and actually making it big without being in Bollywood how do you see the indie music scene has progressed. Where are all those super bands which came out in the 1990s?

Sadu: As I said earlier we were lucky enough to be amongst artists of the golden decade of Indian Independent music. TV and Radio helped Independent music to flourish to a certain extent which ain't today. The sudden burst of Internet in 2003 with free downloads of songs from various websites declined the sales of CDs and cassettes effecting the profits of music companies, ultimately they didn't approach the Independent artists thereafter. The Indian film industry took this opportunity to splash their songs all over promoting them with huge budgets.



In the current music scenario I find Remixes and Cover versions of an old song or a Rap songs. There are few artists launched by big music companies whose songs are totally influenced by film music. Off late there are quite a lot original Indian independent artists across genres whom I appreciate. I have lot of expectations from the young musicians out there, the digital audio streaming platforms have opened up an enormous space to showcase their respective talents. I am lucky enough to own a pharmaceutical company which supports me live my musical passion and dreams without disturbances. I am a gold medalist in MSc Chemistry (specialisation in environmental chemistry & drugs). I am an environmentalist too.

Jay: Your songs are a genre of their own how did you come to it? How do you write, record, and produce the songs?

Sadu: As I spoke about my musical influences which ranges from Carnatic, Hindustani classical, Ghazals, Old Malayalam-Tamil-Hindi film songs, Brian Adams and The Beatles, my personal music creation has zeroed in to a simple melody with easy and understandable lyrics, the arrangement would perhaps change from time and beyond. I love experimentation and am always open to try out new permutation combinations in the arrangement for my compositions. I believe Independent music is one genre where music is a free bird having the never ending desire of prospectives and to explore the unknown possibilities. I do not want to classify my music into one genre but would personally ensure that each new track is ear pleasing, soothing and with the latest captivating sound. I do not deliberately sit down to compose a song, a tune comes into my mind when I get into a mood, that may be emotional, sad or happy, so once a tune pops up I immediately record it on my cell phone. After few weeks I work this tune on my keyboard with fresh mind and later, on the laptop. Once my sine and cross is ready I get started with the lyrical part. Sometimes it's Godly that the tune comes



with lyrics hand in gloves in a flow. Block buster 'Dekha hai Teri ankhon ko' is one of them. Once my composition and lyrics are ready, I get in touch with my music producers which depends on the track profile. I have my perception about the arrangement for a song and would acquire theirs which then finally results in a mutually agreed creation.

Jay: What are your plans for the immediate future? Tell us more about your latest release?

Sadu: I had few releases last year Mausam, Hor kinne suboot lyawaan, ankh se door na ho and Khoj, I recently released a song named Habeeb in April this year. It's composed and sung by me, written by Bashir Badr and the music produced by gemotions media, Mumbai. Habeeb: A profound desire as the name suggests is everything about romance. It is sometimes very difficult to express your heart felt feelings to your beloved. Even worse situation is not communicating or transforming love. The romantic marvel of lyrics fumes out from Habeeb, carefully given a tender tinge it's a sensual saga. The words are magnetic enough to bind two lovers together. It's important to let your partner know how much you miss

her/him, the bond only thickens. The contemporary arrangement with guitars played by Sumesh Parameswar, piano played by Dhrubo, Siddharth and 'saxophone' which is rarely used nowadays played by Josy Alapuzha. I have around eight releases this year, they all are commercial Pop-Rock genre.

Jay: What gives you the kick, writing, recording, or playing live and why?

Sadu: Creating song is a long process, it is rather very stressful and frustrating when you don't find the right complimenting subsequent tune or lyrics. It's after a brain storming effort for months together that you assemble the whole track when you end up smiling and satisfied. Live gigs are always a kick since you have ample of space to renovate and improvise your own tracks. The reciprocation from the audience is a booster which takes you to another level of ecstasy. Being a musician helps me a lot on stage, I have my own Indie songs considerably enough for a concert of 5 hours.

Jay: Where can we find your music on the internet? How much does collaboration with Indie artists worldwide rank in your priority? Will you be open to that possibility?

Sadu: One can visit my artist profile 'Sadu' on any digital music streaming platform to listen to my songs and the music videos can be found on my YouTube channel 'Sadu music'. There is an enormous scope for world music to flourish, hence I think collaborations of like-minded independent musicians can create wonders. I am definitely open to the idea of collaboration with other established independent musicians worldwide.

Jay: What would you suggest to an aspiring independent artist?

Sadu: The fact that Western and Indian old classics are still listened to is only because it thrived on simple melody and good lyrics, your survival and relevancy in music of course depends on the trend of music arrangement and sound of that very time, so with my USP and latest





sound I think I can woo the audience today. There are a lot of musicians playing different styles and genre of music which is limited to a certain class of listeners, but for a Global appeal, reach and better mass communication the spine of a song should be simple melody and good lyrics rest everything follows. Hence my advice to aspiring musicians is there is no shortcuts but endeavors to attain what you desire, don't make or create music for others or do what others do. Go with your own musical instinct and create what satisfies you, raise the bar for self consecutively. Do not sing or record covers and remixes of other artist's song, it in fact lessens your potential and is a complete wastage of talent, I always say that 3 claps for your own song is way better than 1000 for a cover.

Ironically Indian music is dominated by the film songs which are purposely squeezed into the movies for their promotions. There is an immense scope for Original Indian Independent Music to flourish. There is more need to adapt and popularize our own Indian heritage of Classical and Folk music. I Welcome all those beautiful musicians to hit the studio and create magic, I await the dawn For Original Independent Music which would stand alone in the Music Scene of India trampling these mediocre, A New ERA of extraordinary songs awaits to hit the streets.

- Thank you

Photos Courtesy : Sadu

Annemarie Picerno





Annemarie Picerno is a Singer-Songwriter, Comedian, Actress, Theatre Director all in one. She is a Grammy member, Americana Music Association member and an Indie Collaborative Artist. She is a Josie Music Award Winner for her hit song "Bonfire" along with being presented in 2019 and 2020 'The Gran Royale Music Award'. She has topped numerous Top 40 indie radio charts with her powerful voice and harmonies in Country, Rock, Pop, Blues, and American Roots. **Annemarie** teamed up with Bob McGilpin to release her latest single "**Color Blind**". **Lazie Indie Magazine** spoke to **Annemarie Picerno** about her career as an Independent musician her musical influences and also about her plans. Let us check out....



"I think as an artist I never do just one thing, and as an all-around entertainer I incorporate everything I have learned in performing from theater, comedy, and acting to keep adding to my next performance".

LIM: You have had a great career in music so far creating a substantial fan base worldwide for you. When you look back, how do you feel was your journey so far?

Annmarie: It has definitely been a musical journey filled with sacrifices, struggles, and also great joy! I have met incredible musicians, radio and TV-hosts and artists, as well as made lifelong friends. As an independent artist, even when times get tough, I know that I can chart my own course and do what's in my heart and soul in making my own unique music. It is a blessing that it is heard around the world!

LIM: Who/what were your musical influences and how did you arrive at this genre you play?

Annmarie: Growing up I listened to Barbra Streisand, Neil Diamond,

Classic Rock, Etta James, Aretha Franklin, Whitney Houston, Janis Joplin, Patti Labelle and many other greats as well as trained in Musical Theater to sing in big theaters. I had a big voice and learned how to use my many voices in all genres of music. I tend to stay in the American Roots mixing Country, Rock, Blues and Pop with my own unique sound.

LIM: How do you go about writing your songs?

Annmarie: I like to write in metaphors lyrically and tackle challenging subjects with emotional imagery, as well as some with humor. The story and message determines the style of the music and I like to play vocally with different melodies. I usually start simple then build on the emotion and power to the finale of the song with lots of harmonies.



I always have a very definite idea of what I'd like the message to be and put a lot of imagery and the 5 senses in my lyrics and color of my vocal delivery

LIM: How do you record and produce your music?

Annmarie: I record the basic demo on guitar or piano, then Bob McGilpin, my producer, arranges the music with his fabulous style. We talk about the sounds, the emotion and the groove of the song and we never try to sound like anyone else. He weaves the music around my vocals and we have a lot of fun adding the bells and whistles like the harmonies or cool musical licks that add to the overall story and mood of the song.

LIM: Where do we find your music on the internet?

Annmarie: My website www.annmariepicerno.com has all the icons to all my social media sites and music stores that you can click on and follow, as well as on my website you can stream and buy my music, hear my radio interviews, watch my music videos and check out my latest releases and news! If you google my name Annmarie Picerno you may also find some hidden gems from my music history!

LIM: What gives you the kick, writing, producing or playing live and why?

Annmarie: Lately I have been having a lot of fun producing music videos and putting out to TV and media platforms. I'm starting to pull out my theater background and make my music the entire package with the performance and interpretation in the videos as well as starting to write a show that will have my original music and also be a full stage production with characters and story. I think as an artist I never do just one thing, and as an all-around entertainer I incorporate everything I have learned in performing from theater, comedy, and acting to keep adding to my next performance.



LIM: How much of your career is dependent on the internet and its offerings?

Annmarie: I think the internet is constantly changing, and we have to adapt especially when live shows were restricted the past year. Television, online radio and live streams are definitely a great way to stay connected and I stay active with radio interviews, live stream appearances and developing content for TV and stream channels like putting my music videos on Bongo Boy TV, Aim Country Music Television and Roku, Fire TV and other stream sites.

LIM: The covid scenario has created a situation of no live shows for the immediate future ... in your opinion how can an Indie artist tide over this trouble?

Annmarie: Things are easing, but during the lockdown, I recorded new music in the studio, participated in several online shows, and increased my radio interviews. I produced several music videos and stayed creative and busy, so for myself saw no big change as I always have something to do! Live streaming concerts are also becoming more popular and Nashville music venues are back with bands and stages opening

up. There are so many aspects to being an entertainer that TV and video appearances increased for myself and I had to get outta pajamas! lol.

LIM: What are your immediate future plans for 2021?

Annmarie: "Color Blind", my latest radio release and music video is doing well on radio and gaining popularity on charts and TV and video platforms. I also have a new Pop Rock song releasing in spring that I will produce another music video to. I am participating in Sharon Lia's "Ladies Who Rock For A Cause" live benefit concert, as well as getting involved in live music festivals coming up later in the year. I also get out and support my local Nashville bands and help other indie artists with radio airplay, as well as perform live myself, so I definitely keep busy!

LIM: Being a very successful musician yourself what would you tell an upcoming musician to keep in mind when a) he/she is struggling to get recognized and b) once he/she has just made a mark in the scene and needs to sustain here?

Annmarie: Always stay diligent and do something creative every day towards your music, and be professional! Three years ago I became a Grammy member, and not only was it an honor but it introduced me to another realm of professionals in the music industry that have commitment to their craft, talent and drive to create. You must remain true to yourself, but be involved and show up to participate in opportunities that help advance your music, and work with good people. Always show up with a smile and go above and beyond! Don't be afraid to raise the bar, put your struggles and emotion in your music as authenticity is key for others to connect with your story and message. Lastly, think outside the box and never give up!

- Thank you

**Roger
Adams**





Influenced by legends like Roy Clark, Glen Campbell and Jerry Reed, **Roger Adams** started a local band in his home town at Virginia Beach, Virginia named “The Virginia Fire Band”. The band achieved tremendous following playing Country music, Country rock and Southern rock. That was a start of a long career which is still running strong. After decades of entertaining his fans, **Roger Adams** looks back at his songwriting, composing and performing and tells us how he churns out those soul-stirring Country songs as his expanding fan base takes him to new geographies cutting across age groups. [Lazie Indie Magazine](#) spoke to this veteran singer-songwriter who is a member of Country Music Association & Texas Country Music Association and International Singer-Songwriters Association. Let us know more about him...



LIM: You have had a great career in music so far creating a substantial fan base worldwide for you. When you look back, how do you feel was your journey so far?

Roger Adams: I have had an incredible career in music. It started when I was very young and realized how much enjoyment I get from singing in front of people. Singing their favorite songs as they sing along is an electrifying feeling that nobody really understands until it happens to them. At that point you're hooked and you will never stop. This is the same feeling I have today. Whether it's a small or large stage, 5 people or 5,000, the feeling is the same.

LIM: Who/what were your musical influences and how did you arrive at this genre you play?

Roger Adams: Looking back at the influences I've had over the years I would have to say it started with Roy Clark, Jerry Reed and Glen Campbell. They all had great guitar skills and the voice to go with it. I have always been a big fan of traditional Country music.

That became my style as I grew up and I stayed along those lines. Over the years I have built on this style by listening to James Taylor, Alabama, George Strait and Garth Brooks. Staying true to the Country style of music will always be what suits me best.

LIM: How do you go about writing your songs?

Roger Adams: Writing songs has always been about an inspiration. Normally I will come up with a signature phrase or "hook" and build from that. Always trying to tell a story, though not all of my stories are about me, but they are relatable to many listeners who have shared that experience or feeling. I have had the most success writing songs that are true to my life and feelings at the time. People are walking life lessons and we all share some type of heartbreak, sadness or joy for many different things in life. Making songs relatable and everlasting is the key to longevity in this business.

LIM: How do you record and produce your music? Are you particular with any recording gear which you feel is important to bring out the kind of voice you want?

Roger Adams: I have had the enormous pleasure of working with some of the best musicians and producers in Nashville. As I develop a new song, it all starts with a guitar track and basic vocal. Most times I have an arrangement already planned out as far as what instruments should be in the song. As the different musicians come in, they bring their ideas to the table and before you know it, we have a great song. As far as recording equipment or gear, I leave that to my producer in Nashville. There are so many things needed to be "radio ready" that it's best to leave that to them. I will always direct the sound and arrangement but it's best to have a pro handle the technical side of music recordings. But in the end, it's my voice that has to stand out. This is what people want to hear the most.





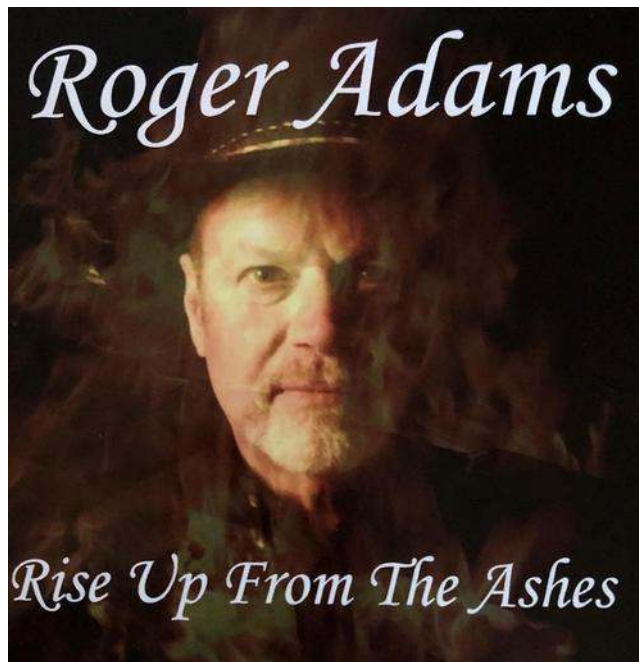
"Stay consistent and true to your style. Your best work is when it fits you the best. Don't try to imitate. Just be yourself. Engage with the fans. Perform as often as you can and continue to tell everyone about everything you've got going on. Fans always want more and are just as anxious as we are to get out and see you. Mingle with your crowd. Be accessible and always be kind".

LIM: Where do we find your music on the internet? Which is your latest release?

Roger Adams: All of my music is available on nearly every digital platform worldwide. This includes Spotify, Apple, Deezer, Amazon Music, I-Heart Radio and Pandora just to name a few. My recent release "Home" has been doing extremely well with Indie radio as well as main station radio. Also there is a large variety of music videos on YouTube under Roger Adams Music. The primary location to find out about me and what I am up to is my web page Rogeradamsmusic.com. This website is updated constantly and will keep you up to date on my music career.

LIM: What gives you the kick, writing, producing or playing live and why?

Roger Adams: Being in the music business as long as I have, I would have to say performing live is the best. You have to enjoy singing and engaging with an audience to have the desire to do everything else. In the end, it's all about the fans. What they like, what they enjoy the most and how that makes you feel when you get them on their feet cheering you on. Recording and writing songs is the foundation of a live performance. That itself is the goal. To make people happy and want to hear my music over and over.



LIM: How much of your career is dependent on the internet and its offerings. How do you see the music scene going from here?

Roger Adams: Today's musicians are all dependent on the internet and social media. These are tools that have become necessary in today's world. However, the social media market and digital platforms allow my music to be heard around the world. This was not the case years gone by so for that reason it's a wonderful thing. The downside is sales. CD's are becoming absolute, so the financial impact of this reduction in sales has been detrimental to many. But everything changes. There will be a new idea, a new type of music distribution that I will be ready for when the time comes.

LIM: What is the way forward for an upcoming band in these difficult times as live shows are a washout, how soon do you foresee, we will all be able to get back to the thriving live scene? Or is the Internet going to be the only way out in the near future?

Roger Adams: I feel the best ways for new artist or groups to gain exposure these days is with the social media and a digital presence. Gaining fans is not an

easy job. It takes work and dedication. Having a supportive team and family always helps. You have to spread the word and don't be shy. Live shows are coming back but even that is not enough. Music is worldwide and extends way beyond your home town honky tonks and night clubs. Performing live is the true enjoyment, but gaining exposure across the world will expand your territory to perform in all parts of the world.

LIM: What are your immediate future plans?

Roger Adams: First let me say, the 2020 was an unusual year for everyone in the world. But for me, I was able to complete the recording of my second album "Rise up from the Ashes", start promotions, start gaining some radio airplay and grew my fan base by significant numbers. 2021 will be no different other than the ability to do live performances again. This I am really excited about. This April is a very busy month between live shows, radio interviews and writers rounds. This momentum is now been extended throughout the year. I'm currently recording my third album now which I am extremely proud of and look forward to an August 2021 release date.

LIM: Being a very successful musician yourself what would you tell an upcoming musician to keep in mind when a) he/she is struggling to get recognized and b) once he/she has just made a mark in the scene and needs to sustain here?

Roger Adams: Stay consistent and true to your style. Your best work is when it fits you the best. Don't try to imitate.

- Thank you

AIR ROSE





Well, Rock n'Roll is back here with style. When you listen to **Ambrose** you can see that the songs have everything a Rock listener wants to hear like the super riffs, the killer vocals, stylish drumming, groove, energy, everything you ask for. No wonder the band is getting hugely popular day by day and their songs are played across the world on the radios. In these days of wayward aimless music, **Ambrose** is a welcome relief for Rock music fans and there are thousands of them cheering for the band. **Lazie Indie Magazine** spoke to **Zak Ambrose** the singer songwriter and he explains in detail like no one else does on how he makes music and we learn why it sounds so good. The music has true soul and spirit of Rock n' Roll. This is a band you must hear and read about if you love Rock music. So let us learn more about them...



LIM: Hi Zak, Welcome to Lazie Indie Magazine, Great to have you speaking to our readers. You have had a rising career in music so far creating a fan base around the world. How do you feel was your journey so far?

Zak: Grateful to be blessed with the ability to express and share the deepest parts of my humanity with others and honored that to be able to connect with those that love music as much as I do.

LIM: Who/what were your musical influences and how did you arrive at this genre you play?

Zak: Everything I've ever heard and experienced has been an influence in some form, though when seeking out music to listen to I tend to gravitate to those works that are classic in by nature. I've never been one to fit in a box, so it's hard to define by genre but I've always loved songs that make you want to sing and play.

LIM: How do you go about writing your songs?

Zak : To truly answer this question, I must first define what I have come to know and understand is the true essence of music. Without a deeper understanding of the power of music, it is

impossible to ever embark on the journey of creating a powerful musical experience. Music is the universal language of the soul which provides us with an immediate means to transcend space and time as we experience it, communicating directly to one another on a spiritual level. Since its inception, music has been used to create a magical or spiritual experience by opening a window to which we can peer directly into the essence of humanity.

Music serves to amplify and secure the spirit of those whom create it, while preserving their culture and history for as long as it is practiced. Creating music is an intuitive process by which a conductor taps into the ethereal plane, constructing a bridge which connects us to the deepest aspects of our humanity. When harnessed correctly, a musical movement represents pure human intention transcribed from this higher plane, forming powerful and lasting spiritual connections. It is in this way that the musician is a magician and is in fact creating a magical experience for all those participating. A great artist knows this on an intuitive level and over time will develop their own unique ceremonies to allow for a more conductive and creative experience. The stronger an artist's connection to the ethereal plane is, the greater their ability to transmit pure intention through their music becomes. So, I begin this magical process by paying attention to these fundamentals, while doing my best to set the stage for the magic to happen.

1) Identify when and where I'm heading to "get it out". It is important for every artist to surround themselves with those things that inspire them the most as well as to eliminate those persons, places and things from the equation that will prohibit their ability to successfully tap into the etheric plane. This means finding a secure and quiet place with a neutral or positive inherent energy to create in. The optimal place for me to plug into inherent intuition is when I am surrounded by nature. So many of my favorite songs have been written while sitting by a campfire under the starlit night.



Astrological alignments have a role to play in harnessing your creative force as well, but this is another topic another time.

2) Eliminate all external expectations and hone in on your pure intention. This will entail cleansing the surroundings from any negative distractions and or things that may trigger unwanted outside stimulus. I will stay sensitive to anything that might bring me into my ego or project ego into the moment. For this to happen I prefer to either be alone or with a trusted and proven collaborator that reinforces or amplifies the creative process. This person is a muse in some sense whom sees you for your true creative self while helping to elevate your “intangible” energy. It is important that these persons understand how important it is to stay in the moment and are also inherently able to stay in the moment.

3) Once settled in I will do whatever is necessary to begin to tap into that place where my instinct can take control and my mind can wander elsewhere. I attempt to tune in on an intention that’s been floating around in the subconscious in one form or another. This can be a riff, whisper or an emotion I need to alleviate

which usually will form a type of visual depiction in the abstract mind. I do my best to allow my soul to speak through me and then riff off the waves I’m tuning into, allowing the manifestation to come together however it sees fit to.

4) Track all of the initial movements. We now have the ability to record everything we do where ever we may be. The initial movements will be 80-90% accurate in how it should be represented in its optimal form. This is the moment where having a keen and experienced producer to help tune in and capture the essence of the moment can really help to make the magic happen. I’ve tracked entire songs in their initial improvised state, words and all which come out very close to their final form. “Houston”, “Oceanside” and “Two Minutes To Paradise” are just some of the tracks that came out in their final form.

5) The final step is to refine the piece, honing in on its most potent and optimal form. This entails performing the new song live with a band or solo in front of a live audience. A great producer will also play a key role in helping to identify how to bring the new track to its most potent form. Once you know you’ve got the goods to move the souls of others you are ready to track the final version.

LIM: How do you record and produce your music? Who helps you do it or is it home done?

Zak: When it comes time to track a new song, I will put everything I have into getting this done at the highest professional level as possible. I love working with Anthony Focxs as we have a long and trusting relationship. I always prefer to have an engineer that knows what they are doing to allow me to focus on harnessing the most powerful performances possible.

LIM: Where do we find your music on the internet?

Zak: I usually find new must by word of mouth. If it’s through a station, it’s by means of a trusted DJ / PD such as Ramona Cox whom spends every day sifting through hundreds of songs to bring us the very best new music from



"The most powerful advice I've received is to realize that this is a journey with no end, no finish line and that you must enjoy the journey. Enjoy and appreciate the creation process and how amazing it is that you have the ability to do so. Use this time to enhance your ability to become a more powerful artist through mastering your craft. If you are true to your art, your art will be true to others as well. Hold nothing back"...

around the world. Luckily there are those that love music as much, if not more than musicians do and live to bring new music to our ears.

LIM: What gives you the kick? Writing, producing or playing live and why?

Zak: The entire process is an unbreakable one. There's nothing that will beat the magic of a packed house all united in the moment through a live performance. After experiencing this, the soul will crave to stay in this moment for as long as possible.

LIM: How much of your career is dependent on the internet and its offerings? How do you see the music scene going from here?

Zak: It's huge, but I'm not a tech guy and this is perhaps a major downfall for Ambrose at the moment. It's a major strain on an artist having to deal with all

of the aspects that a record label once took care of.

LIM: What is the way forward for an upcoming band in these difficult times as live shows are a washout, how soon do you foresee, we will all be able to get back to the thriving live scene? Or is the Internet going to be the only way out in the near future?

Zak: Optimal songwriting and capturing the moment will always be the historical records for every generation. Becoming more interactive by setting up a studio that can be used for live streaming is key now, along with allowing the audience to participate in everything you do. Capturing and sharing the magic of the moment will always be the key for a successful artist.



LIM: What are your immediate future plans for 2021? Have you toured out of your country and would you like to tour to Asia/ India maybe once the world opens up again?

Zak: It's going to be a year in which I will be doing everything I can to create and share new material, while finding the optimal ways in which to share the live experience. I am hoping to be able to find new artists to collaborate with on productions as well as ways to perform with a live audience. I've produced an album for an artist by the name of Savannah Lynx and it was one of the most rewarding experiences of my life thus far.

- Thank you

Courtesy: Ramona Cox.

**Samantha
Noella**





Started at the age of 5 and turned into a professional by 14 and now with more than 2 decades of music creation and performance behind her, it only takes a few minutes for **Samantha Noella** to lift a listener to a totally different plane with her music. She is also an all rounder who is an Educator with her institute of repute called Scattitude that churns out many professional musicians. **Samantha** is one of the most popular vocal coaches in Mumbai and has a number of certifications in music to her credit which in turn helps her to raise the bar with each performance she delivers. **Lazie Indie Magazine** spoke to this phenomenal artist and she took time to tell us about her journey so far and her plans for future too...



LIM: Hi Samantha, Welcome to Lazie Indie Magazine, Great to have you speaking to our readers. You have had a great career in music so far creating a fan base in across the world. How do you feel about your journey so far?

Samantha: I have indeed had a fulfilling career in music for such a long time. I really feel this has been one hell of a ride. Music has shaped me into the person I am today; it taught me resilience, patience, hard work, and authenticity. Music, above all, has taught me to make a difference, even if it is in a small way. I still have so much to do, and every day for me feels like I'm just getting started.

LIM: Who/what were your musical influences and how did you arrive at this genre you play?

Samantha: I have had numerous musical influences, some great teachers while growing up, who introduced me to Louis Armstrong and Ella Fitzgerald, Barbra Streisand. Other strong influences would be Whitney Houston, Mariah Carey, Anita Baker, Dianne Reeves, Aretha Franklin, Michael Jackson. As a young jazz enthusiast, I was introduced to Carmen McRae, Thelonius Monk, Horace Silver, Chet Baker, Anita O'Day, Koko Taylor, Etta James. My genre is a combination of all the different music I have sung over the last 3 decades, so contemporary music singers describe me best.

LIM: You also Founded Scattitude Academy of Music. why and how did you start this and how is it going now?

Samantha: I decided to start teaching in 2006 because there were no contemporary teachers to help develop modern music vocal techniques here in Mumbai. From being just me teaching, we grew to a small set up of 4 teachers. We called the school Muziworks at that time. Over the years, we rebranded from a home-driven one-person set up to a formal company known today as "Scattitude Academy Of Music"; a name that embodies everything we do:- Scat - innovate, improvise, Attitude, stage presence, performance, as well as



etude-education. Today, we offer voice, piano, music theory, song writing, music production and guitar.

LIM: How do you record and produce your music? Who helps you do it or is it home done?

Samantha: I am very grateful to have a fabulous team to help put my music together. Initially, I lay the track down at the school with Faustin Missier - Co-Founder of the school, then we send it to our producer in Nashville who works on the song. It goes back and forth till we have a fix on it. Once the track is final, I record vocals here at Purple Haze (studio) with sound engineer Vrigpal Khambay and then send it back for mix and master. Faustin Missier then submits the track to the distributor and he works on the videos too.

LIM: Where do we find your music on the internet?

Samantha: My music is available across several streaming platforms like Spotify, Apple Music, Amazon Music, Wynn, Resso, Gaana, Youtube, Saavn, Hungama, Deezer, Tidal, Napster many others across the globe.

LIM: What gives you the kick, writing, producing or playing live and why?

Samantha: Music gives me a perennial high. I truly feel blessed because I survive doing what I love best - breathing, living and making music all the time. Being on stage for me is my way of letting off steam or unleashing, as much as a way for me to express myself, play with the music and showcase the use of my skills and artistry. Making music is exciting; my creative juices work in overdrive. When I listen to the final product, I feel scared, nervous, excited, and eager to share my music with the world.

LIM: How much of your career is dependent on the internet and its offerings. How do you see the music scene going from here?

Samantha: At this point in time, I would say we are totally dependent on the internet for our careers, be it for live shows or music education. We were indeed fortunate to move entirely online, last year even before the lockdown came into effect. I want to say that had it not been for the internet, I wouldn't have reached out to all our students across the globe. The internet made more avenues accessible.

LIM: What is the way forward for an upcoming band in these difficult times as live shows are a washout, how soon do you foresee, we will all be able to get back to the thriving live scene? Or is the Internet going to be the only way out in the near future?

Samantha: The future is Hybrid. You need to be able to Live-stream, at the same time, be ready for on-ground events. Given that more prominent festivals are finding it difficult given the current situation and are postponing or cancelling festivals, I guess we need to hope that the vaccine drives it effective and can go back to on-ground gigs and festivals.

LIM: What are your future plans? For your own music and your academy?

Samantha: My immediate goal is to finish my Level 2 Modern Vocal Training Certification while simultaneously working on, writing, and releasing new music for 2021-22; to release one song a



month. On the school front, we hope to expand to more territories both in India and overseas.

LIM: Which is the best advice you have got so far in music and what would you advise a co-musician to make it successful in his career in music?

Samantha: I would have to say the best advice I got so far in music is to keep working on your craft, innovate, reinvent and share the knowledge you have collected and worked on. Stay grounded and work as a team player, especially when playing in a band. Play as a unit, play as a collective. Play, so each musician has the freedom to grow and evolve, develop and make magic together. Practice hard, practice daily, practice with focus. Don't mistake talent for artistry. It must be updated and worked on regularly and holistically - Thank you.

Music for World Peace Records





Music for World Peace Records is an Indie record label with an ambitious mission: using music to convince the world, from individuals at the grass roots level to international political leaders, to reject war and embrace peace. The U.S. based label was founded in 2020 by Taylor Sappe, a composer and producer with over 50 years in the music industry and Mike Turner, an award-winning songwriter and poet. **MFWPR** fosters collaboration between songwriters, performers, producers, engineers and graphic artists to create original songs that advocate world peace and love, and oppose war and violence. [Lazie Indie Magazine](#) spoke to **Taylor & Mike** on how and why they started the label and how do they go about picking artists to promote.....



LIM: When and how did you come up with the idea of starting **MFWPR** and why did you choose to do it?

Taylor & Mike: Taylor is a Vietnam veteran - an experience that showed him first-hand the horrors of war and gave him a deep sense of its waste and futility. Once back in civilian life he embarked on a music career, and through the years developed a growing sense that his work in music could contribute to ending war. In 2020 Taylor decided the time had come to form a group of people to fulfill his dream of using music to change the world, and he reached out on social media to find out who might be interested. Mike, a songwriter and poet whose 27-year Federal law enforcement career gave him an up-close view both of international arms trafficking and the impact of crime and violence on everyday people, had already written several pro-peace/anti-war topical songs, and responded to Taylor's outreach. We decided that forming an Indie label to create and release original pro-peace/anti-war was a worthwhile endeavor, and Music For World Peace Records was born.

LIM: What kind (mainly genre) of music do you usually promote?

Taylor & Mike: We're open to all genres of music. We've already released songs in Country, Folk, Pop, Rock, Adult Contemporary and World Music genres, and we'll consider any song in any genre that's on point with our message of promoting peace and love, and opposing war and violence.

LIM: As an independent artist how does one get noticed by your talent managers and If someone wants to submit music to you how do they contact you?

Taylor & Mike: Anyone with original, unreleased songs on our central pro-peace/anti-war themes, can submit them for our review at our website submissions portal, <https://musicforworldpeacerecords.com/submit-your-music>

LIM: What would you look forward to in an artist? What do you look for in particular in the demos?

Taylor & Mike: We'll look at just about anything as long as it's on point with our pro-peace/anti-war message - partial or fully developed lyrics, song demos, fully produced tracks. About the only thing we're not interested in are instrumental pieces - we want music with a more active message, and that requires lyrics (we do release some instrumental meditation music compositions, along with Jazz and Folk instrumental pieces, on our subsidiary label, Captain Blue Records). When needed we'll pair the submitter with other songwriters, musicians and vocalists, and producers and recording/mixing/mastering engineers - whatever it takes to bring a project to release. Singles for release must meet the technical specs required by the service provider we use (currently CDBaby) for upload to the major streaming services, like Spotify and YouTube - Taylor is in charge of our final quality control to ensure the upload requirements are met.



LIM: How do you help the artist as a label to reach the world of listeners? Could you elaborate on that aspect?

Taylor & Mike: Once a single is released, we immediately upload the track to our website, where it's available for streaming and donation-based download; and we start the process of working through our service provider to upload the track to the major streaming services - it normally can take four to six weeks for the provider to upload the tracks to the streaming platforms. We publicize our releases on social media, not only with posts on our own pages and groups but also in various music groups; and place articles with international music magazines. One of our long-term goals is to build out a robust radio distribution operation, but right now we only place songs with individual radio DJs when opportunities present themselves.

LIM: Post-COVID lockdowns live music is taking a hit. What do you foresee in the music industry? Do you expect the live music scene to return in full flow or is it going to be reset with new realities?

Taylor & Mike: It's hard to predict the eventual impact of COVID, lockdowns and any continuing need for social distancing on the music industry. Our personal belief is that we'll see long-lasting changes in live performance, particularly in medium- and large-scale performance venues. At the same time it's our thought that there are enormous opportunities in social media-based live performances - things like YouTube and FaceBook live, pay-per-view performances, Zoom performances. That's a good part of the reason we've structured Music For World Peace records with social media as an integral component of our business operations. The industry "reset" could be a real boon to performers reaching their listeners, particularly in targeted markets like ours.

LIM: How can a label like you be of help to talented upcoming artists in a period as stressful as this?



Taylor & Mike: One of our big goals is to provide indie artists - particularly those writing/performing the type of topical music we're pushing - an outlet for their creative works. Far too often indie writers and performers have to do everything on their own, and they don't get the chance to work in a supportive, collaborative environment that values and supports their creative talents. We want to give our writers, producers and artists that supportive environment, and get their music, and its important message, out to the world.

LIM: As veterans in this field spotlighting many artists over the years what would you give as advice to upcoming musicians?

Taylor & Mike: Follow your creative instinct. Don't let the "music industry" divert you from what you feel is your path and your message as an artist. And use your talent, your voice, your music to say on the issues we all share, to compel

positive action to make a better world. Music can entertain - but it can also inform, enlighten, motivate and literally change the world. That's our goal at Music For World Peace - to influence planetary change through music, one song at a time - and we encourage that to be the goal of the writers, performers and producers whom we work with. And recognize that it takes a team to have success in the music field - know the value of networking, play to your strengths and leverage the talents and abilities of others - like us - to support your success. For more information and to join us, visit our website at www.MusicForWorldPeaceRecords.com. Be sure to check out "Our Business Model" at the website - we're using a system that's unique in the music industry to make sure everyone who contributes to a release shares in its success - Thank you

Jeff Stone





The Tomiko Dixon Grand Blues Review presents veteran Blues Musician **Jeff Stone**, the WC Handy Award Winner. He can wail blues harp with the best of them. Along with Harmon and the Mid-South Blues Revue, **Stone** won the IBC (International Blues Challenge) in Memphis in 2004. A decade and half later **Jeff Stone** is currently working with Charlie Love and the Silky Smooth Band, the Grand-Daughter of the Blues- **Tomiko Dixon**, and also Gospel-infused work with Mississippi Gabe Carter. **Tomiko** speaks to **Jeff Stone** on behalf of **Lazie Indie Magazine...**



Tomiko: Who inspired your project and or music?

Jeff: The inspiration for my music comes from life itself; my own and others. What I witness, hear and feel others go through, as well as all the twists and turns of my own life, inspire me to speak through my instrument, to reach and touch listeners. Muddy Waters, Otis Rush, B.B. King, were amongst the first that got my attention. But was when I first heard Little Walter on the Chess Records of the late 50's and 60's that convinced me that the harmonica was to be my voice. He was the glue...the syrup...the piece that brought it all together.

Tomiko: Who would you most like to collaborate with and why?

Jeff: On the Gospel side of things, I would love the opportunity to collaborate with Charles Jenkins, Fred Hammond; someone on that level as they are innovators, who have brought and continue to bring Gospel music to an evolutionary level. There are many Gospel musicians and singers here in Chicago that I would love to work with, to bridge styles that would allow for a deep expression through music that taps into inner faith. On the Blues level, I have

been and continue to be blessed to have worked with, shared a stage with incredible artists, from Chicago to the Delta, to Southern California and through Texas. Exploring new flavors on traditional works or methodology. On the Delta-side, someone like Trenton Ayers and/or R.L. Boyce. That would Dig deep into the roots music I was blessed to be a part of for 10 years playing alongside Rev. KM Williams. On the big city blues side, Vasti Jackson. Vasti is a Mississippi Legend, but a multi-faceted artist who can help incorporate all the different styles that make up my blues style. On the Chicago dep-rooted side of me, I would say Tomiko Dixon. Not just for the connection to Willie Dixon, but in her own right, as a vocalist based in the blues, but reaching out to different horizons.

Tomiko: What is one message you would like to give other artists that are inspired to get into the entertainment industry?

Jeff: Find that inner voice that is begging to surface. Do the homework and study your craft. Allow yourself the time to perfect what you do..., have a job or other means of income that allows you to do the necessary work to become who you want to be. Find your mentors...and stick with them! Study...practice...put everything into every performance...as though it may be your last time ...whether 10 people or 10.000 people...leave it all on the stage, in the studio...carry yourself with respect...this is your true self.

Tomiko: Which entertainer do you admire the most and why?

Jeff: Rough question, as there are so many that meant so much to me as I began as a kid and grew in life. Muddy Waters, B.B. King, Little Walter, Big Walter, James Cotton, Sonny Boy Williamson (I and II,) Junior Wells, Miles Davis, Oscar Peterson, John Coltrane, Otis Rush, Luther Allison and so many others. The one that stood out to me the most, was and still does, is Willie Dixon. Why? Without Wille Dixon, the Blues as we know it would not be what it became during and after his everlasting influence. As a writer, promoter and producer, he



single-handedly transformed and defined the Blues that migrated from the Mississippi Delta up to and through Chicago during the 50's and 60's. His signature was on just about every significant production out of Chess Records that produced most of the great performers of that era and gave the world America's artform and legacy of the Blues. As a business icon during a time that was not easy for Black entrepreneurs to flourish, Willie built an empire that taught others as well as providing for his family for generations to come.

Tomiko: What is the best advice given to you?

Jeff: The great Lowell Fulson, when living late in life out in Los Angeles was playing a show, backed by my brother Jeff Dale's band. Timeframe was circa late 1980's. I asked Jeff, if he would let me sit in on the last set, so I would get the opportunity to play with Mr. Fulson. Honestly, it was a bit overwhelming to be on stage with this legend of the Blues. I didn't know what song we were going to play, but at least got the bass player to tell me what key we were in. Lowell Fulson was used to playing with horns, so I laid back and played horn rhythms behind

the groove. About halfway through the second verse, he turned to me and smiled and said 'let me hear you.' I took my space and the lead and then very respectfully gave him back the lead. We finished the song and the set. As I walked up to him to thank him and tell him what an honor it was to play with him, the great Lowell Fulson said to me, 'Look here, Jeff Stone. You have your own style and know where to play. Never give that up. Keep developing your personality in your playing. It makes you be you.'

Tomiko: What's next for you?

Jeff: Coming out of COVID, I would say performing some shows. Working on a new project with original material mostly. Throughout the last year, I picked up an endorsement from Seydel harmonicas which give more of the craftsmanship that other manufacturers have moved away from. My sound is paramount to me, for my playing and the Seydel harmonicas allow this to and for me.

Tomiko: Do you have any upcoming events?

Jeff: A few tentative shows and events, solely based on the reopening...and safety.

Tomiko: How would you best describe your music or project?

Jeff: My music is a culmination of Blues, Jazz, Gospel, Soul, R&B, formulated into my style that complements, enhances, fills the total output of whatever project or performance. Leads are great, but the real art is the comps, hits, fills...the contribution and the groundwork for everyone involved to peak their performance. My music comes from deep within my soul...speaking a language all to its own...



Tomiko's Final Review

Jeff Stone's music is a culmination of Blues, Jazz, Gospel, Soul, R&B, formulated into a style that complements, enhances & fills the total output of his projects & performances. His music comes from deep within his soul and it speaks a language all to its own. There's no doubt about it Jeff Stone is doing his part to keep the Blues alive & thriving. On a scale from one to five. (5 being the highest) I personally rate his music and project a 5. I know Jeff Stone personally and I'm extremely impressed by his many talents & showmanship. He's a great musician and definitely embodies the spirit of the Blues.

Long Live the Blues Everyone!!!



About the Reviewer

*This column is contributed by **Tomiko Dixon** who is the granddaughter of the Great **Willie Dixon** and also the youngest inductee to the Blues Hall of Fame and an Ambassador of Blues. **Lazie Indie Magazine** is glad and honored to join her cause to keep the spirit of Blues alive.*

Photos Coutersy: **Jeff Stone**

Gary Harvey





THE GARY HARVEY BAND

GHOST DANCE



Through his various bands and now mainly as a solo acoustic act, **Gary Harvey** is known for his strong Country/Blues roots, passionate style of performing & a few tall stories. His songwriting is very much influenced by Americana but his long career & many influences have made him very eclectic, as he says the only rules are there are no rules. His bands have always had a strong presence in the live music scene, with numerous festivals, tours and TV appearances; he remains active recording and producing new material. The last release with the Gary Harvey Band, Ghost Dance has been critically acclaimed and is available on iTunes and Spotify. [Galaxy FM- New Zealand](#) interviews **Gary Harvey** ...



Galaxy FM: For the benefit of our readers can you kindly introduce yourself?

Gary: Hi y'all, I'm a Gary Harvey singer songwriter from Auckland New Zealand, I play bass guitar, guitar, harmonica & I've been around since Jesus was a baby.

Galaxy FM: Since when have you been into music?

Gary: I got into music in the 50's after watching Elvis in King Creole, I thought to myself that's a good job I wanna do that, very much like John Lennon I do believe. Around the time the Young Ones movie came out with Cliff & the Shadows I got asked to play bass for a local Shadows cover band & the rest as they say is history.

Galaxy FM: Who were your musical influences and how does it reflect in the genre of music do you create?

Gary: My main musical influences came through the British blues boom back in the sixties John Mayal, Cream, Free, Led Zep leading me in later years to the Texas sound eg Stevie Ray Vaughan, Fab Thunderbirds etc. These days I'm very eclectic, but it's classed as americana.

Galaxy FM: How do you go about writing your songs?

Gary: Writing songs I find relatively easy these days, they sometimes start from a guitar riff or pattern, sometimes from things I've seen or done that click the brain into gear. As Mark Knopfler said about song writing, your mind is like a junkyard you just put stuff into it & when a song happens you just pull stuff out.

Galaxy FM: What do you look to convey to your listeners when you create music do you look to set a lyrical theme first or you let the music dictate the lyrics?

Gary: I like to tell stories with my songs, but the things I've written about will always be interpreted differently, hopefully opening a door or emotion, sometimes just making the folks get down a boogie.

Galaxy FM: How do you record and produce the songs?

Gary: I usually record ideas on my ph then go the studio lay down an acoustic &



guide vox with a click track, it then goes to the drummer, I put the bass on, then get the guitar done by whoever we want on the track, then keys same deal, last we do the main vox, then mix it most of the musicians we use are based in the US mixed with locals.

Galaxy FM: What are your plans for the immediate future? Tell us more about your latest release?

Gary: I'm planning on doing a solo tour of NZ later this year & we've put together a new band called Whiskey Train with Jesse Wilde, who is a singer songwriter, the drummer from his old band Henrik Rylev & Tony Abbott, the guitarist I've played with over twenty years. We will be recording & filming a live album in Jesse's studio in Auckland for a live audience later in the year.

Galaxy FM: What gives you the kick, writing, recording or playing live?

Gary: These days I enjoy writing & recording more, I don't get the buzz from

playing live as much as I used to mainly, because the gigs have changed or disappeared, but we're really looking forward to playing live with the new band from the one gig we've done so far it should be great.

Galaxy FM: Where can we find your music on the internet?

Gary: There's three songs from my new album Outlaw & all of my last album Ghost Dance with my band on Spotify both albums are on Bandcamp or my site <https://garyharvey.co.nz/> & can be purchased through either.

Galaxy FM: What would you suggest to an aspiring independent artist?

Gary: My advice to anyone wanting to make a career out of music, if you believe in yourself just go for it & see where it takes you it's a rough ride at times but if you hang in there you'll get out of it what you want, I do it because I enjoy what I do it sure as hell ain't about making money to our fame - Thank you.



About the columnist

Around the Galaxy is a column contributed by **Galaxy FM 107**, New Zealand, introducing artists from New Zealand and Australia. Galaxy FM is one of the top radio stations in New Zealand and is quickly expanding its listener base across the world. The authors of the column, **Barbara Harkins** and **DJ Grant** are well known radio hosts at Galaxy FM hosting the popular Breakfast Show. **LIM** thanks team Galaxy for their support. Check out their website- www.galaxyfm.co.nz



Vijit Malik





Vijit Malik is a Dubai-based Classic Rock, Blues, Country Rock and Folk singer. His repertoire draws heavily on the classic era representing artists like The Beatles, The Eagles, CCR, S&G, Eric Clapton, Pink Floyd, Grateful Dead... He has been a frequent performer on the music scene in Dubai performing both individually as well as with leading bands Roots and The Desert Ramblers. Roots recently performed live in-studio on Dubai Eye 103.8 FM on 'The Night Shift' with Mark Lloyd. **Vijit's** easy and interactive style will have the audience on their feet for hours on end with his seemingly endless reservoir of classic songs. He has developed a unique form of rhythm accompaniment and exemplifies the term "One Man Band". **Darshan Shankar (Dats)** spoke to **Vijit Malik** on behalf of **LIM**. Check out..



Dats: For the benefit of our readers please introduce your self?

Vijit: My name is Vijit Malik and I am a regular performer on the Dubai music scene both as an individual artist as well as with leading Dubai bands 'Roots' and 'The Desert Ramblers'.

Dats: Since how long have you been into music? How did you come into music?

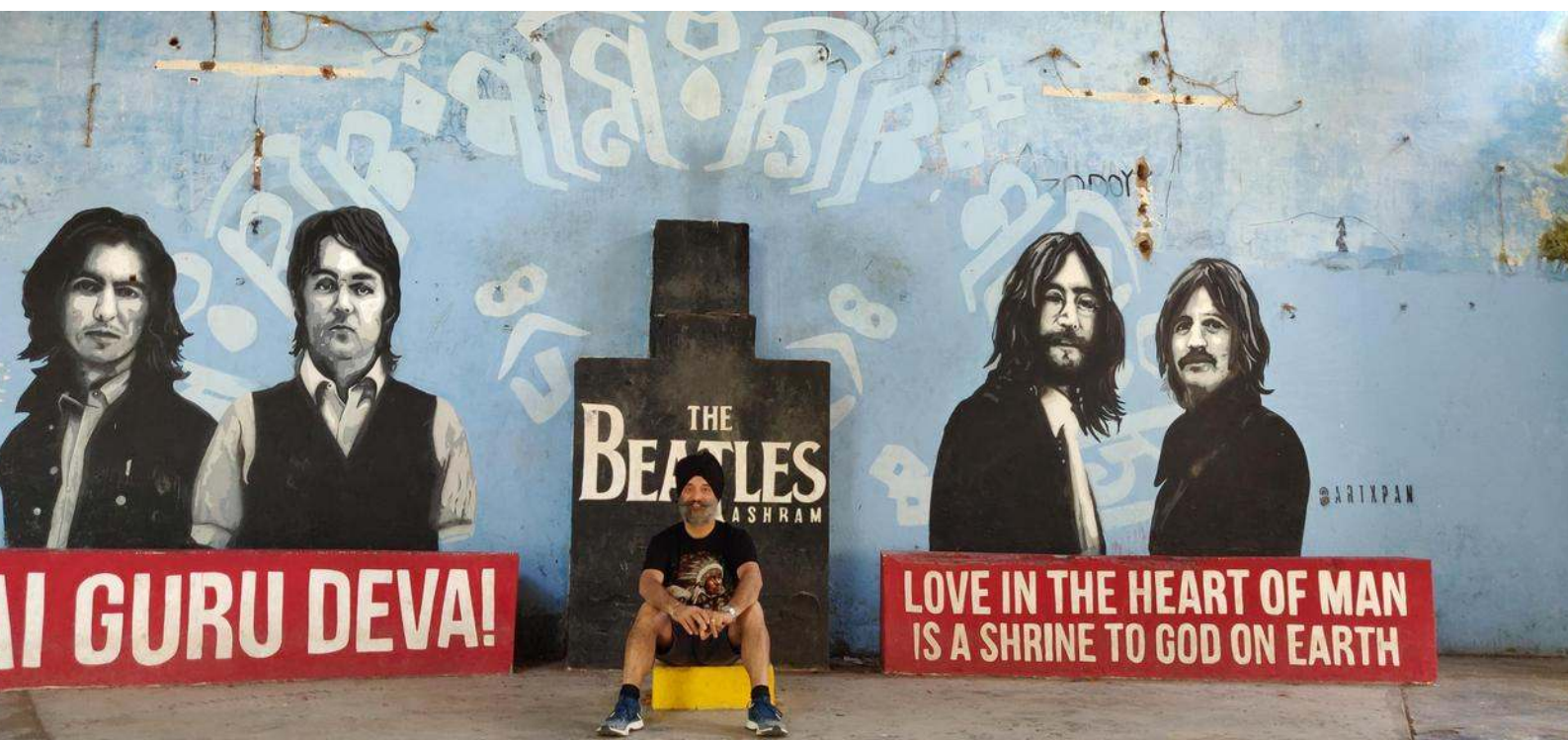
Vijit: My musical foundations are in Hindustani Classical music and I learned to play the Sarod (an Indian string instrument) at an early age whilst studying at the Doon School in Dehradun. With that foundation and having pursued higher education in the United States, I branched out into guitar and currently also play the mandolin, ukulele and the Bazouki.

Dats: Who were your musical influences?

Vijit: Whilst studying in school in India, I was also part of a choir that sang Hymns and Christmas carols in four part harmony and that inculcated in me a deep love for vocal harmonies. This early influence led me to a deep appreciation of artists like Simon & Garfunkel, Crosby Stills Nash and Young, The Eagles, Peter Paul and Mary and more recently the Milk Carton Kids. And of course one of the most influential bands of all time, The Beatles!! The improvisational nature of Hindustani music also influenced my choice of Western musicians and I was drawn instantly to the music of jam bands such as the Grateful Dead as well as artists like Bob Dylan, The Band and Jorma Kaukonen.

Dats: How do you go about writing your songs? In case of your band who writes the songs and how?

Vijit: I started writing songs much later in my musical journey as initially the thought of trying to create something worthy of my musical gurus was quite intimidating. It finally dawned on me that all artists draw reference or influence for their songs from some other song or event and this led me to writing a handful of songs. The one that I am most proud of is a song called Rishikesh that draws its lyrical inspiration from the time that



"Follow your dreams always and believe in yourself. YOU CAN DO IT!"

the Beatles spent at the Maharishi Maheshyogi's Ashram in the late 60's. The music is influenced by a song of Pink Floyd that I happened to be listening to at the time.

Dats: How do you record and produce the songs?

Vijit: I have spent a lot of time trying to perfect the art of home recording and hence most of my songs are mixed, mastered and produced at home using basis recording equipment and a Digital Audio Interface. On 'Rishikesh' though I was very fortunate to have the help of a dear musician friend of mine Paul Joseph who helped mix and produce it.

Dats: In your opinion has the internet helped your music pursuit and other independent artists?

Vijit: The internet has been a huge

support in my musical journey as it provides a readily available platform to put your product out in the public space. Not only does this create awareness for your music, but also gives you the confidence that your product is worthy through the appreciation of the online audience.

Dats: What are you plans for year 2021 and immediate future?

Vijit: I'm definitely looking forward to being very active musically both online and in returning to live music once the Covid situation improves. One of the benefits of the lockdown has been the mushrooming of online musical platforms where one has met and been able to collaborate with so many other wonderful musicians.

Dats: What gives you the kick? Writing, recording or playing live and why?



Vijit: Playing live is probably the most rewarding musical pursuit as you are able to establish a very direct and strong connection with your audience. This in turn inspires you to reach deeper and once in a while the result is truly magical!

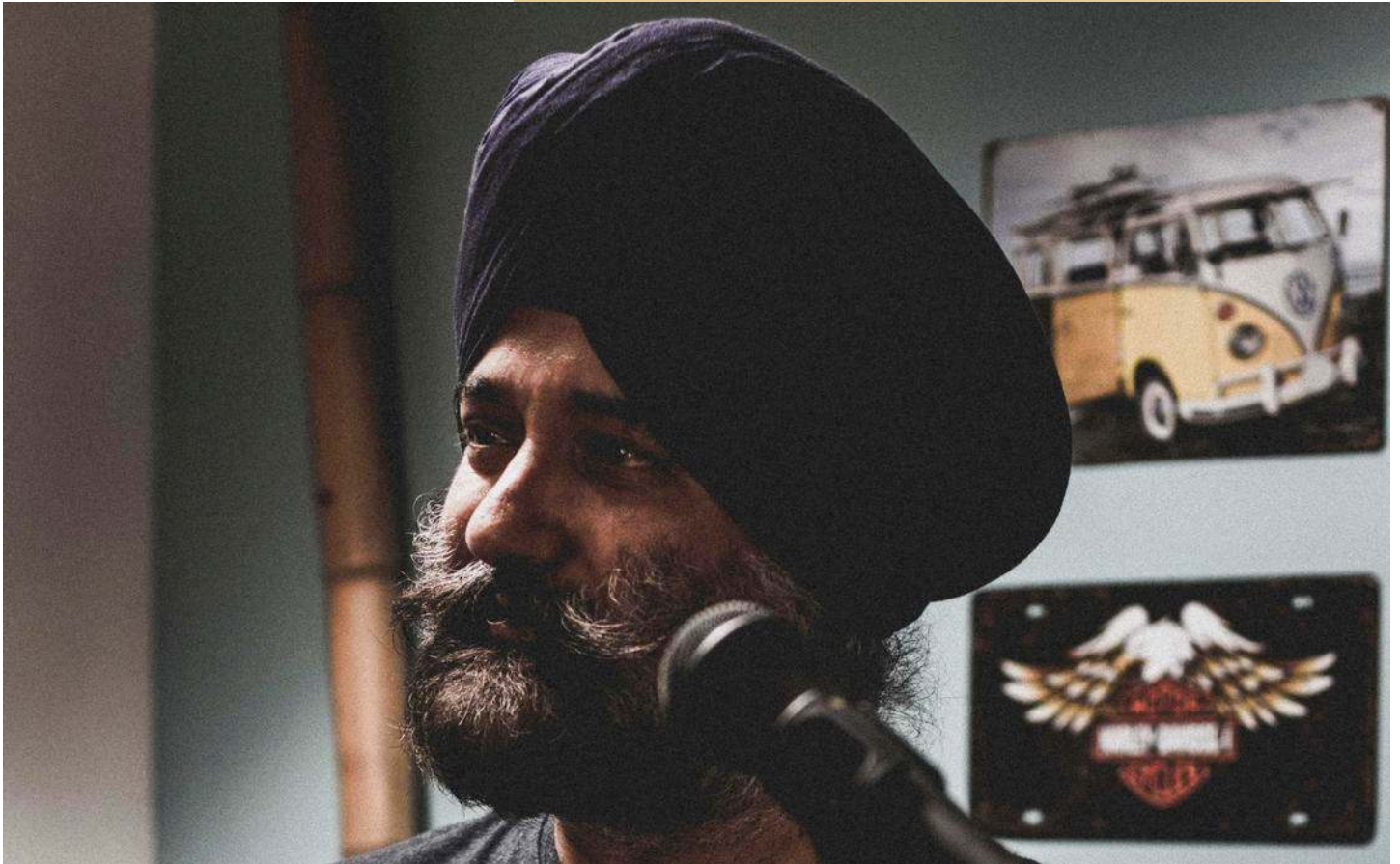
Dats: Where can we get your music on the net?

Vijit: Youtube link - <https://www.youtube.com/channel/UCOoQRqrFq70Kwgjyhe3ajAw>

Facebook link - <https://www.facebook.com/Vijit-Malik-Music-for-the-Soul-105732161293679>

Dats: What would you suggest to an aspiring independent artist?

Vijit: Follow your dreams always and believe in yourself. YOU CAN DO IT! - Thank you



About the columnist

Darshan Shankar is a popular singer and has been the frontman for many top acts such as the legendary Indian Band 13 Ad . He runs a very successful event company in the Middle East. Darshan has also been a very active promoter of Independent Music and has conducted many festivals and other events promoting Independent Rock Bands in India and Middle East. Lazie Indie Magazine thanks Darshan for his column **DATs** Column which will from now on, introduce great musicians from across Middle East to **LIM** readers.

Photos Courtesy: Vijit Malik





SOUL CHATTER



Soul Chatter is a Great Lakes-based Indie Rock band creating Indie, Folk-influenced, White soul and Retro. They take the lyrics pretty seriously and work to create soul stirring compositions that stay with you, make you want to dig in a little. Intelligent, melodic, listenable rock songs with strong melodies, crisp guitar and understated keyboards. [Lazie Indie Magazine](#) spoke to **Brian Stepien** about the band, how they came together, how they create music and what is the way forward for them. Let us check out ...



LIM: For the benefit of our readers can you kindly introduce yourself?

Brian: My name is Brian Stepien. I write our music and lyrics, I play keyboards and sing and for Soul Chatter, an Indie Rock project that originated from Cleveland, Ohio. Current members of our band include Jim Monica (guitars), Will Fox (bass), George Hart (drums) and Mike Docy (engineer). We strive to create soulful, meaningful, memorable songs for a diverse audience.

LIM: How long have you been into music?

Brian: I have been writing songs for many years, being obsessed with music since early childhood. I was lucky enough to work with an amazing keyboardist starting out, he taught chord structure and the value of a good riff. After several years of only providing lyrics, I took on all writing duties. I have been happily dabbling in composition ever since.

LIM: Who were your musical influences and how does it reflect in the genre of music do you create?

Brian: I think of my first influences as being very old school : Van Morrison, Elton John, Counting Crows. I was obsessed with Motown since I heard it for the very first time. I think of strong melody, lyrics that paint a picture, songs that take you to a wonderful place. In more recent years, key influences include storytellers like Jason Isbell.

LIM: How do you go about writing your songs?

Brian: I typically begin with a lyric. I am an avid traveler; inspiration often comes from the road. I will scratch out my thoughts, work out a melody. Singing in the shower, in the car, on a walk. Chords, rhythm, pace are layered in afterwards. Each bandmate is given free reign, so the end result is a bit of a journey.

LIM: What do you look to convey to your listeners when you create music do you look to set a theme first or you let the song take over your lyrics?

Brian: Lyrics are very important to me and there is always a theme.



I write about the journey, about growing, aging, isolation. Sound dire? There is a hopeful thread throughout all our work. I believe in the random nature of life, not in predestination. I think we are all just trying to figure it out. I believe in hope, not faith.

LIM: How do you record and produce the songs?

Brian: In this pandemic, we trade WAV files electronically. I now live in North Carolina, as does our bassist Will Fox. Our guitarist, Jim Monica and drummer, George Hart, are living in Cleveland. I record the piano, vocals and a scrap drum track then pass it on for others to add their parts. After that, Mike Docy adds the spit shine.

LIM: What are your plans for the immediate future? Tell us more about your latest release?

Brian: Our latest release is a single called 'Mad River'. It is a song about creating chaos and retreat and redemption. Sometimes the only real option is to cut ties and start fresh. We are also working on some additional new recordings and a video project for our song 'Forever in a State of Leaving'.

LIM: What gives you the kick, Writing, recording or playing live, and why?

Brian: Every aspect is fun for me, but my favorites are the writing and recording. The creative process and having something permanent and created in collaboration. That is so amazing to me. Taking your fresh recording to the car after a late recording session and play it while you ride through town? That's priceless.

LIM: Where can we find your music on the internet?

Brian: Soul Chatter can be found all over: From Spotify and Apple Music to Deezer and Amazon. Our band's website is SoulChatterMusic.com.

LIM: What would you suggest to an aspiring independent artist?

Brian: It is not enough to write and perform great music. Everyone wants an audience. Build that audience through live performance, networking and hard work, but be careful. The internet is filled with questionable characters, almost always for a fee up front. Do your homework. But most of all, have fun. Making music is all about cooking up fresh food for the soul.

- Thank you



BREEZER

VIVID

SHUFFLE

GET READY TO SHUFFLE WITH

VIJAY & KRITI



**LIVE
LIFE IN
COLOUR**



BREEZER Vivid Shuffle is a competition organized to find the best talent in Breaking, Popping, Rap, Graffiti and Hip-Hop Showcase - cementing its place as India's biggest hip-hop league. **Lazie Indie Magazine** spoke to the winners of each category in the league to share their success stories and also to **Arti Hajela Senior Brand Manager, RTD, AMEA at Bacardi** the organizer of the **Breezer Vivid Shuffle** who shared the overall success story of competition as the top Hip-Hop league in India. She also gives us a perspective from a top brand executive on why a brand like **BREEZER** involves itself in the promotion of Hip-hop in India, whether they have plans to expand it to other countries and make it international and a lot more things. It is quite interesting... ..Check out folks there is a lot in here!



*Lazie Indie Magazine spoke to **Arti Hajela** Senior Brand Manager, RTD, AMEA at Bacardi the organizer of the **Breezer Vivid Shuffle**.*

LIM: Hi Arti, Welcome to Lazie Indie Magazine! You are now into the 4th Edition of the Breezer Vivid Shuffle looking back at the past 3 edition and the way it has grown did you really expect this to be a runaway success? And in your opinion what created the space for the event?

Arti Hajela: BREEZER Vivid Shuffle was conceptualized as a platform for India's burgeoning Hip-Hop movement, to represent the Hip-Hop talent in the country and enable a stage for expression to an art form that speaks the language of the streets. At the beginning, we knew it would be an uphill task to promote this subculture in the mainstream conversations. However, we had complete faith in the talent of the country and their hunger to showcase it, and hunt for the right opportunities. Over the years, we've seen this drive in budding artists and that has helped make the platform bigger.

LIM: Can you please tell us about the core team that is behind BREEZER Vivid Shuffle?

Arti Hajela: BREEZER Vivid Shuffle is truly a cross functional team effort, with the brand teams working closely with Digital, Insights & Commercial teams; along with the team at OML.

LIM: Why and how did you conceptualize this? Why this format and why Hip-Hop?

Arti Hajela: Hip-Hop is the voice of the youth in our country and helps them express their experiences, while also breaking barriers of class and language, making it more accessible. At the same time, it has strong community building ethos and inherently looks at celebrating the ideas of the artists and communities they represent. These values of community building and celebrating resonate strongly with BREEZER's Live Life in Colour brand persona.



LIM: How can one participate in the competition? And how are they evaluated?

Arti Hajela: We've always kept the participation process very simple for BREEZER Vivid Shuffle from the very first season. This year too, it was very easy. Individuals had to simply register themselves on PayTM Insider. In January, the registered individuals showcased their talent through virtual auditions wherein they simply had to upload and share their entries on Instagram by tagging the BREEZER Vivid Shuffle account. The entries were assessed by some of the most celebrated national and international artists from the Hip-Hop community namely Bam Martin, Daku, Seedhe Maut and Dizzy One among others.

LIM: What are the highlights of the past editions which you can share with us?

Arti Hajela: BREEZER Vivid Shuffle was started as one of India's first and biggest Hip-Hop dance festivals, in 2017. The platform was curated to bring opportunities to the country's burgeoning Hip-Hop talent and bring the subculture in mainstream conversations. In line with this aim, each year the platform travelled

across the country to discover and promote the best dance talent. This year, we took it a notch higher despite all the challenges and transformed into India's biggest Hip-Hop league, going beyond dance to music and art as well. This translated to five categories of Popping, Breaking, Hip-Hop showcase, Graffiti and Rap. At the same time, going completely virtual for the first time enabled us to break geographical boundaries and help everyone get a chance to Live Life in Colour. The response was overwhelming and has furthered our commitment to the platform. We're now working toward making it bigger in the fifth season.

LIM: The Covid Restrictions brought the live concerts to a halt and also the livelihood of a lot of artists especially the ones who are full-time into their art. What do you see in the near future for these artists? Will it be all on the internet or will the real thriving performing scene return soon?

Arti Hajela: The recent times have been challenging for all, more so for artists. BREEZER has kept its commitment to the Hip-Hop community through BREEZER Vivid Shuffle this year too, despite all the challenges to ensure artists get a platform to showcase their talent and opportunity to pursue it further. We also brought enthusiasts and budding artists a chance to hone their skills through 'School of Shuffle' workshops. We've been doing our best to provide a platform to artists in these trying times. The thriving performing scene is slowly coming back. In fact, it has started in smaller forms with safety protocols. And hopefully, these will be scaled soon too. In the future, we believe hybrid models will be adopted across board i.e., a combination of on-ground plus digital to sustain the on-ground vibe as well as break-free of geographical boundaries.

LIM: Lazie Indie Magazine is read across 25 countries from where we have featured independent and recognized musicians. Where do our readers check out for more details on #BreezerVividShuffle? is there anything you would like to tell them?

"We're always striving toward making BREEZER Vivid Shuffle bigger and better each season, and bring opportunity to more artists to Live Life in Colour".

Arti Hajela: BREEZER Vivid Shuffle focuses on driving the Hip-Hop culture to a new realm wherein every talented individual is recognized and all elements of Hip-Hop i.e., music (rapping), art (grafitti) and Dance (popping and breaking) are well celebrated. We would urge Hip-Hop artists across the globe to leverage this platform to showcase their talent at BREEZER Vivid Shuffle. The platform also provides an opportunity for artists to up their skillset with the School of Shuffle by BREEZER Vivid Shuffle where some renowned artists from the industry host workshops. As we gear up for the next season, interested individuals and Hip-Hop enthusiast can stay updated with the latest announcements and details on BREEZER Vivid Shuffle's Instagram account.

LIM: How has been your journey for the

past editions as a sponsor or a brand backing the event?

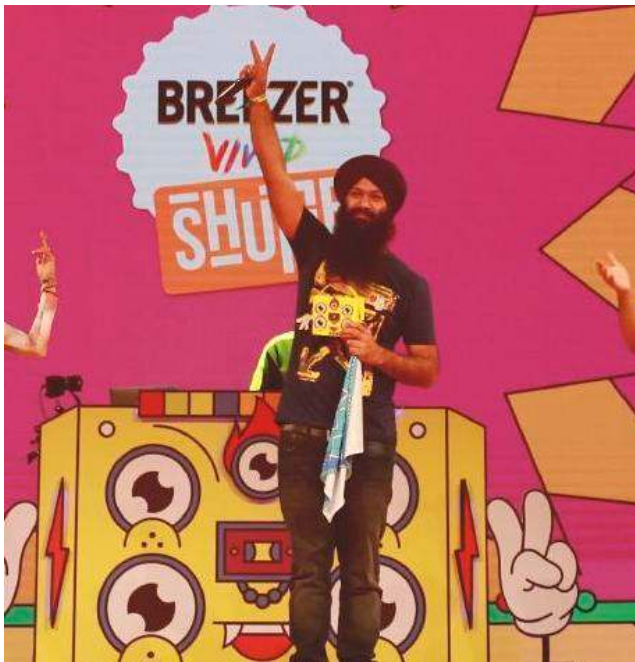
Arti Hajela: BREEZER is not merely a sponsor of BREEZER Vivid Shuffle, we've co-created the platform with OML. It has been an extremely satisfying journey due to the overwhelming response by audiences and the Hip-Hop community. And we're more committed than ever to make it bigger and help more artists and audiences Live Life In Colour.

LIM: What is the future plan vis a vis BREEZER Vivid Shuffle? BREEZER has a huge amount of experience and resources at your command, would you be looking to expand the ambit of this Competition to International levels? Can there be a sustained challenge or "next level" to an artist who comes in and reaches the top in the competition?



Arti Hajela: We're always striving toward making BREEZER Vivid Shuffle bigger and better each season, and bring opportunity to more artists to Live Life in Colour. We will continue working toward this commitment. While going international is on our radar, we're yet to iron out the details. Overall, we'll continue to focus on what's right for the platform and the consumers - Thank you.

Courtesy: Srishti Bhargava.



Breezer Vivid Shuffle

Winner: Rap

GD 47 - Gagandeep Singh

LIM: How do you feel about winning this prestigious competition?

GD 47: When my name was announced as the winner, I felt like I was waiting for this moment for a long time. I prepared myself for the competition wholeheartedly and came to win. I was overwhelmed from the response that the audience gave me for my performance. That was my favourite part of the competition, to have the Hip Hop community appreciate my raps and being able to get that response live was the icing on the cake for me. The format of the competition was very exciting and nail biting.

LIM: How do you think winning this would help your career as a Rapper?

GD 47: The recognition that BREEZER Vivid Shuffle stage gave me was exactly what I was looking for. Obviously, the opportunity to meet the team leaders, the judges, the organisers and the contestants gave me a better validation of how good I am at my art-form.

The exposure, the confidence boost and the love altogether just gave me more drive.

LIM: What are your Music influences and why did you pick up this genre?

GD 47: I started listening to Eminem and he's been the biggest influence on my rapping style, but I try to take the best from all the rappers I listen to, from 2Pac to 50 Cent to Jay-Z to Lil Wayne to Drake to J Cole. From focusing on their rapping styles, rhyme schemes & structures to their ideologies, personalities on & off the mic. I've always tried to pick whatever resonated with me. Rap for me became my therapy, it became my way out of my own mind. Hip-Hop just spoke to me as a culture which is for the oppressed to fight for their rights and voice their thoughts in a powerful and impactful way and it makes me happy that a platform like BREEZER Vivid Shuffle is trying to bring the subculture to mainstream conversations.

LIM: Where do we find your work on the internet?

GD 47: Youtube, Instagram, Facebook, Spotify, Beatstars, Soundcloud.

LIM: What are your future plans?

GD 47: To turn my dreams to reality. An EP, an album, countrywide shows. I never ran after fame, my main purpose of making music has always been to help myself and others through my music. I want to leave behind an impact that will change the world for good. As for the Hip-Hop/Rap Industry in India, I want to be able to contribute to the music scene and help budding artists to have a fair chance to do what they love and make sure their art is valued.

- Thank you



Breezer Vivid Shuffle

Winner: Breaking

Bboy Tornado - Ramesh Yadav

LIM: How do you feel about winning this prestigious competition? How do you think winning this would help your career as a dancer?

Ramesh: I had worked hard to get into BREEZER Vivid Shuffle, India's Biggest Hip-Hop League and winning such a huge title was a great achievement. The level of competition at the League was intense and battling through that to emerge as a winner has really given me the much needed confidence and push to compete with bboys internationally, something that I've been wanting to do for quite a while now.

LIM: What are your dance influences and why did you pick up this genre? (Dance influences)

Ramesh: I got attracted to the dance form looking at 5-6 boys performing the same in my neighbourhood. Initially they didn't let me practice with them, but once they saw my zeal and passion to learn they agreed to teach me. I was 14 when I started bboying and the love for the art has only increased since then.

LIM: Where do we find your work on the internet?

Ramesh:- Instagram- tornado.ramesh, Facebook- bboytornado, Youtube- bboytornado

LIM: What are your future plans?

Ramesh: I feel I'm made for the big things in life so I'm now focusing on participating in International competitions and competing with artists from all over the globe.

- Thank you



Breezer Vivid Shuffle
Winner: Popping
Neeraj Pandey

LIM: How do you feel about winning this prestigious competition?

Neeraj: I won this competition last year and winning it consecutively for the second time was like a dream come true to win amongst so many worthy competitors. I have been working hard for a very long time and winning the League proved that hard work doesn't go waste.

LIM: How do you think winning this would help your career as a dancer?

Neeraj: BREEZER Vivid Shuffle is India's biggest Hip-Hop league. Winning the title has not only helped me physically and mentally, but I'm also getting a lot of work opportunities to showcase my art to people around the nation. And more importantly, it's giving me a chance to Live Life in Colour and keep dancing.

LIM: are your dance influences and why did you pick up this genre? (Dance influences)

Neeraj: When I was a kid, I would always do robotics, waves and many other similar steps, while dancing without knowing that this is what Popping is. Gradually, when I learnt about the art form I just kept falling in love with it. My dance influences would be Prashant Bisht, my teacher, who introduced me to Popping as a genre and Himanshu Pandey, my brother, who inspired and motivated me to push my limits.

LIM: Where do we find your work on the internet?

Neeraj: All my work is available on my Instagram @neeraj13777

LIM: What are your future plans?

Neeraj: Winning BREEZER Vivid Shuffle has literally got me Living Life in Colour and dreaming big. I am focusing on participating in International Popping Competitions and representing India.

-Thank you



Breezer Vivid Shuffle
Winner: Graffiti
Mooz One (Raj Pathare)

LIM: How do you feel about winning this prestigious competition? How do you think winning this would help your career as a Graffiti Artist?

Mooz: BREEZER Vivid Shuffle, went beyond the realms of dance for the first time and included Graffiti. It feels amazing to have won the first ever Graffiti edition of the League. Winning this competition not only adds to my achievements but also provides me with a wider audience for my art. It has added more colours to my life and in the pursuit of my art.

LIM: What are your dance influences and why did you pick up this Art Form?

Mooz: I was good at drawing since childhood. Graffiti being a part of

the hip-hop culture always drew my attention towards it. I started doing it in 2012. My influences usually came from comics, cartoons, anime and many more which is why you can see some bright use of color, characters and shapes used in my artworks!

LIM: Where do we find your work on the internet?

Mooz: You can find my work here: Instagram-mooz.one, Facebook- mooz graffiti, Youtube- mooz graffiti

LIM: What are your future plans?

Mooz: To keep Living my Life in Colour and keep exploring different aspects of my art, develop my skillset and make a sustained career.

- Thank you



**Breezer Vivid Shuffle
Winner : Hip-hop Showcase
Creative Dance Crew**

LIM: How do you'll feel about winning this prestigious competition? How do you think winning this would help your career as a Hip-Hop Showcase crew?

CDC: Being India's Biggest Hip-Hop League, it is not easy to reach to the top in BREEZER Vivid Shuffle. We had been trying for the past two years and finally winning this year was a huge accomplishment for us. Participating in the league has helped us a lot as we always wanted to participate in International shows as well and BREEZER Vivid Shuffle had an International Judges Panel who gave us the much needed feedback for us to compete with International talent.

LIM: What are your dance influences and why did you pick up this Art Form?

CDC: Showcasing involves a lot of teamwork and we knew we could pull it off. This art form makes us happy and lets us Live Life in Colour. We would like to spread the happiness and the energy.

LIM: Where do we find your work on the internet?

CDC: Instagram- [@creative_dance_crew_india](#)

YouTube - [Creative Dance Crew India](#)

LIM: What are your future plans?

CDC: We would love to represent India in International competitions and with BREEZER Vivid Shuffle's title on our head, we are sure we'll be able to do this soon. We're also gradually working on fulfilling our dream of having our own academy.

-Thank you.

